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Whoz: Building an Agentic Operating Model (A)

On a sunny October morning in 2025, Jean-Philippe Couturier, co-founder and CEO of Whoz, leaned back in his chair, reflecting on his company's transformation. In just a few years, Whoz—a play on "who is" the right person to staff for a specific job—had grown from a promising French start-up into a leading provider of AI-driven talent and project management solutions tailored for IT services, engineering, consulting firms, and other business services. Founded in 2016, it had grown to 100 employees and was trusted by major industry players such as Capgemini, Atos, Devoteam, and Akkodis. More than 800,000 professionals across 115 countries depended on Whoz's software.

Whoz had established itself as a pioneer in digital staffing solutions with an AI-driven SaaS platform that covered the entire staffing process: from mapping skills and identifying talent gaps to workload planning and activity forecasting. By allowing organizations to view their global pool of skills and availability in real time, Whoz's platform helped them build more agile workforces and turn workforce management into a competitive edge. The platform's results were measurable, leading to faster staffing cycles, less bench time, and better profit margins.

Meanwhile, the company had seen significant productivity improvements internally, prompting organizations to ask Couturier to share how Whoz had achieved such levels of efficiency and quality without proportional workforce growth. Central to this internal shift was Coday, an enterprise-grade orchestration layer and AI assistant developed within Whoz. The name Coday—short for companion and day—symbolized the idea that AI-powered systems with agency, known as agents, could serve as partners throughout the workday. Initially created as an internal trial, Coday quickly became a vital part of Whoz's operations. It was embedded within organizational workflows and connected over 40 specialized agents across technical and business domains. Teams across various functions noticed that their work became faster, more consistent, and of higher quality. The tool's use spread naturally throughout the company, generating curiosity outside and sparking internal discussions about its future potential.

Yet, Couturier now faced a strategic crossroads. The success of Coday had opened new possibilities—but also created new tensions. Managing the simultaneous development of the Whoz core product and Coday was becoming more complicated. Couturier reflected, "We're getting more

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and more requests for features for Whoz and Coday." Should Whoz spin off Coday into a standalone venture to capitalize on growing external interest and the broader market potential for agentic AI tools? This way, Whoz's core offering would stay unchanged, preserving its clarity of purpose and avoiding the distraction of building two parallel systems. Or should it integrate Coday more closely into the core Whoz product, creating a unified solution that combined human and agent orchestration? Alternatively, should Whoz open-source Coday, to ensure its future? Each option carried different implications for investment, organizational focus, and long-term positioning.

As Couturier prepared for an upcoming board meeting, he knew the question went beyond product strategy. It tackled core issues like organizational learning, knowledge ownership, and the future of work itself. The internal gains from Coday were clear, but whether those gains could—or should—be externalized was still uncertain. With the company planning to fundraise in 2026, he needed to get clarity quickly. The decision he made would shape not just Coday's path but also the future of Whoz.

Whoz

In 2005, Couturier founded consulting firm InovenAltenor, which grew to 60 employees and nearly €20 million in revenue by 2012. He reflected, "I didn't want to do my staffing manually, so we built software that matched the skills of our people to our clients' projects." He added, "A lot of professional service companies came to me asking for a license for it, but we pushed back saying, 'We're doing consulting, not software.'"

In 2013, Orange Business Services acquired the firm, with Couturier remaining for another two years. On considering his options after leaving, he recalled, "I saw that a staffing software still didn't exist." He co-founded Whoz with a group of 20 co-founders to address the market gap—"If we're very good, we can catch 10%. And if we're not that good, 1%. So, my market is between 2 billion and 20 billion." Whoz set about targeting large players with a solution that met global standards, which Couturier believed was the only viable path. "Otherwise," he said, "you offer an all-in-one vertical solution for smaller companies—and you typically lose money on customer acquisition."

Couturier's founding philosophy was to "make it big or fail fast. If you're designed to fail fast, you become smarter. You need to find ways to get cash. Either you're viable, or you're dead very quickly." Having a large founding group meant the company could bootstrap and begin working on a product without external funding, which in France would have been a difficult prospect. On the other hand, the unusually large founding group made aligning on early decisions difficult. Couturier explained, "Three months in, no one could agree on the core features of the product. We had to say either we deliver something in the next three months, or we stop the project and everybody gets their cash back."

In September 2019, Whoz acquired its first customer. The COVID-19 period grounded business discussions in 2020. Couturier said, "It was an eye opener for professional services CEOs—they realized they didn't know what their people were doing and what skills they had, so they were not able to restaff in real time. Second, staffing became glocal—both global and local—with the move to hybrid ways of working. And, third, private equity firms started to increase their investments in the professional service industry and push for more industrialization and digitalization."

By 2021, Whoz was signing clients with thousands of employees. The company came on Capgemini's radar and was asked to join its Request for Information (RFI) for staffing solutions. Couturier recalled, "We thought, they will never make a deal with us. We're 30 people, we're full of debt and we've no proof that our solution will work for 300,000 people." Still, Whoz advanced to the Request for Proposal (RFP) stage. Couturier said, "It was like an army operation—everybody was

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working on the deal, day and night." Whoz won the deal in December 2021, a milestone that marked a step change in the company's scale and operational maturity.

Investment followed: in 2022, PSG Equity led a €25 million round. Whoz began scaling headcount, particularly in R&D and sales, while adapting the product for global performance. CTO David Palita recalled the challenge: "On the dev side, onboarding a lot of people quickly meant a decrease in individual productivity." In 2023, Whoz refocused on client acquisition, winning Atos, and later a global deployment for a US-based large consultancy, which Couturier called "a game changer."

The founders summarized the company's culture in the acronym TEAM. Couturier explained, "We define the team as a group of people that trust each other—the 'T' is for trust. 'E' is for engagement. 'A' is for ambition—we want bigger projects, a bigger mess, bigger challenges. Our mission is to grow the company. 'M' is mastery; it means that everybody works to be among the best, being up to date in terms of skills, knowledge, etc." He added, "Simplicity is not part of the culture; this is really one of the challenges of the company from the very beginning." Structurally, Whoz operated with a board overseeing strategy and budget, and an executive committee organized across revenue, the 3D Factory (design, data, development), and support functions. (See **Exhibit 1** for Whoz's organizational chart.)

The Whoz Product

Whoz built its offering on the belief that staffing was a key source of competitive advantage. In an environment defined by talent scarcity and increasing specialization—intensified by the COVID-19 pandemic—the market for talent recruitment and retention had become highly competitive. Organizations were under pressure to deploy talent more intelligently and more rapidly than ever.[1]

Whoz identified the "agile organization" as the emerging dominant paradigm. As competition, technology, customer expectations, and regulatory conditions changed at increasing speed, organizations needed to be able to respond and adapt quickly. Agility required both flexibility and stability: the ability to redeploy the best talent to evolving business needs, while creating a coherent, skills-based foundation for the entire organization. In human-capital terms, this meant continuously matching skills, capabilities, and employee interests with changing business priorities—and applying skills-based logic to hiring, workforce planning, pay, performance, leadership, and management.

To support this shift, Whoz designed its product around a metaphor of the talent supply chain. It articulated an agile talent operating model with four interconnected components—strategic planning, skills supply management, demand management, and operations management—linked together through a continuous feedback loop. (See **Exhibit 2**.) Using this framework, Whoz mapped 60 different processes around staffing across the organization.

Delivered as a SaaS solution, the Whoz suite consisted of Talent Cloud, Business & Staffing Studio, Performance Analytics, and supporting modules for data protection and system integration. The Talent Cloud was an AI platform that mapped internal skills and talent available to professional services organizations, giving companies a real-time overview of their available workforce.[2] From its inception, Whoz used AI to build a skills ontology based on online sources. "A skills ontology is a neural network where every skill is connected," Couturier explained. "Each skill can be represented as a vector, meaning you can compute the distances between them." Using this ontology, Whoz created profile vectors for individuals by scanning their CVs and generating a proposed list of skills for validation (see **Exhibit 3**). "You may have nine or ten skills in your CV that it detects," Couturier noted, "but thanks to the skills ontology, a consultant might end up with forty proposed skills to validate."

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The Business & Staffing Studio matched the right people to the right projects by combining skill profiles with availability, ensuring optimal staffing decisions and higher project performance.[3] (See **Exhibit 4** for the home page interface and **Exhibit 5** for the staffing board.) Performance Analytics tracked clients' resource-management data—such as activity rate, billable full-time equivalent (FTE), and margin rate—analyzed them and presented the results in a customizable dashboard. This allowed managers to monitor performance indicators and optimize staffing decisions over time.[4] In November 2024, Whoz introduced the concept of augmented skill, enabling organizations to quantify the performance impact of agentic AI on project teams. "It lets people track what kinds of skills they augment by using AI," explained Chief Product Officer François Gros, "and compare the productivity of a given project team using AI versus not using AI."

Coday

Coday began as a personal productivity tool in early 2024. Whoz Senior Developer Vincent Audibert initially created it to reduce the repetitive tasks that slowed his work. "I saw that ChatGPT was getting traction, and I feared I would miss out on something or would be left behind," he recalled. "I delved into the topic, and the first iteration of Coday was essentially an interactive loop in the terminal that helped me assess the models' capabilities at the time. I saw that there was a real potential to go further, to use Coday every day to help me code."

In its early form, Coday functioned as a single, developer-centric assistant embedded in Whoz's engineering workflow to support everyday development tasks. At the time, most available frameworks for agentic development were Python-based, while Whoz's technology stack relied heavily on Java. Audibert chose to stay within the company's stack and built a purpose-designed solution that leveraged multiple large language models (LLMs). He integrated Coday with key internal systems—including Jira, Confluence and Git—laying the foundation for specialized agents that could read, write, and refactor code; run builds and tests; manipulate project files; and access documentation. Each action was permissioned and logged, and agents could initiate, execute, validate, and document workflows within established guidelines. Early external tools lacked this breadth of integration, as mature multi-connector platforms such as MCP did not yet exist.

Coday as a multi-agent developer tool As its potential became clear, Audibert created additional agents, each with their own domain of operational or technical expertise. They automated development workflows and captured the nuances of Whoz's evolving software architecture.

When Audibert presented Coday to Couturier in June 2024, the CEO was impressed by his initiative and recognized its capacity to shape the company's future, "I thought, this is going to become a real strength for us because we've been building this culture of AI from the very beginning. We realized that Coday could be the foundation of our broader agentic ambition."

By summer 2024, all of the developers were using it on a daily basis. As David Palita explained, "Coday came before AI-powered coding agents like Claude Code, Codex, and Gemini CLI. We used ChatGPT for more general questions, but it's not integrated with our systems—you have to copy and paste, which is a horrible workflow, and it didn't have knowledge about Whoz. Coday immediately yielded incredible results compared to other tools within the dev community." Within a year, integrating agent workflows and codifying tacit knowledge led to a 49% improvement in global code delivery productivity, even as complexity grew. (See **Exhibit 6**.)

The emergence of Coday's memory system As developers worked with Coday, it logged every interaction—bug solutions, architectural decisions, nuanced workarounds, and feedback loops.

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Using this information, it extracted contextual metadata such as the nature of the problem, the code involved, human rationale, and outcome. Coday learned not just what the team produced, but how it solved problems, creating a living record of development practice. Audibert explained, "Documentation that's manually written is already outdated—I wanted the model to accumulate knowledge dynamically. If I use the agent on a part of the code base, I want it to be able to learn from how we worked so that it can be reused later."

This information accumulated into a structured, multi-layered memory system: user memory for individual preferences and past interactions; project memory for codebase- and feature-specific knowledge; and organizational memory for processes, technical architecture, and business priorities. The memory evolved through continuous usage. After a long working session with Coday, Audibert found he could ask Coday, "'What did you learn that you did not know at the beginning?' It was able to synthesize a piece of memory and express it in a very human-readable way, as we do for documentation." Over time, the memory became richer and more interconnected as Coday appeared in more workflows and touched more teams. As Audibert described it, the tool was becoming "a long-term memory of the company and a kind of enterprise operating system."

According to Couturier, the memory function was Coday's true differentiator: "Then you have the real, true knowledge base of the company—you're making the tacit explicit." Couturier continued, "LLMs will improve, and as they do, will give you your context information. Thinking patterns—you can write, more broadly, this is what consulting companies are doing when they write processes. But the memory—the way you work—is the real gamechanger that Coday can generate."

From memory to orchestration As agents multiplied, Coday evolved into an adaptive orchestration engine that used memory to understand intent, select the right agent, retrieve relevant context, and coordinate multi-step workflows. Its orchestration went beyond simple routing. It surfaced institutional knowledge, provided relevant reminders, and provided continuity across interactions. While agentic outputs in Coday were anchored in standardized structures, such as release notes and troubleshooting guides, the content generated within them was non-deterministic. This framework was essential for maintaining consistency, accelerating localization, and improving organizational quality. (See **Exhibit 7** for an overview of Coday's orchestration.)

Company-wide expansion via web interface In fall 2024, Coday was migrated to a web interface, opening it to all Whoz employees. Adoption expanded quickly beyond technical teams as product managers and later non-technical departments began experimenting with agents. "It was available for everyone to use, test, and get a glimpse of what an agent can do," said Audibert.

Regular presentations, workshops, and dedicated sessions at company events introduced employees across all departments to Coday's potential. Whoz leaders drove adoption by identifying practical opportunities to create and use agents tailored to specific workflows in their teams. In addition, the developer team made resources available to support the creation and refinement of agents, and to improve the overall Coday experience. Couturier said, "We want everyone to adopt an agentic approach. Coday could be magic, but if nobody uses it, then you don't catch experience in the long-term memory file."

As usage broadened, Coday began to reshape collaboration across the company. By routing requests across functions, it broke down departmental silos and created shared access to organizational intelligence, allowing teams and leaders to make data-driven decisions. Routine coordination—approvals, notifications, handoffs, and compliance checks—became automated, allowing teams to focus on judgment, creativity, and strategic tasks. Perhaps most importantly, Coday preserved critical knowledge, reducing risks during personnel transitions and streamlining onboarding for new hires.

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By encouraging every employee—from developers to executives—to build and interact with their own agents, Coday democratized experimentation. "The good thing is that when you, as CEO, build your own agent, people can't say it's too difficult," Couturier said. "I'm the CEO, I know nothing, and I'm able to build one." Employees soon began experimenting and making productivity gains by creating their own agents. The catalogue of agents ranged from document writers and Jira experts to marketing assistants and financial advisors. (See **Exhibit 8** for further examples of Coday agents.)

Governance, architecture, and limitations Whoz identified new custom agents through an organic, bottom-up process. Any employee could surface the need for a new agent through everyday use of Coday. Departmental leaders played a key role in recognizing recurring opportunities within their respective workflows. A central capability—anchored in the developer team—provided architectural support and governance, with senior leadership endorsement reinforcing agent development as a strategic organizational priority.

Coday was designed to mitigate the risks of hallucination and overreach by grounding agent actions in systems of record (e.g., Jira, code repositories, documentation) and enforcing strict boundaries on agent autonomy and access. When requests fell outside an agent's defined scope or lacked sufficient clarity, Coday did not improvise; instead, it escalated to human expertise, requested clarification, or executed only the components it could reliably complete while explaining its limitations. Through these defined "zones of autonomy," permission guardrails, and intentional human-in-the-loop escalation, Coday prioritized organizational reliability and governance. Audibert's decision to keep Coday's framework simple and tool-agnostic allowed it to grow alongside LLMs, leveraging their increasing scaffolding and guardrails.

Even as Coday transformed how Whoz worked, it faced limitations. Most of its operations still required human initiation—an employee had to launch an interaction, such as reviewing a Jira ticket or analyzing a GitHub event. "We want to move towards a forever running agent that is able to trigger itself," said David Palita. Achieving this required continuity of interactions and deeper integration with everyday tools. Some key systems—such as Notion for collaborative documentation or Basecamp for project management—were not yet fully integrated. As David Palita noted, "We have to meet people where they work. We need to bring in data from emails and Google Drive. It's not yet fully integrated."

Memory governance posed design and privacy hurdles. The nondeterministic nature of memory introduced risks of data leakage. Coday retained information at the user, project, and organizational levels, with strict permission controls. Sensitive domains like HR remained out of scope. "We need to code the segregation of memory in Coday to extend it throughout the whole organization," Couturier cautioned. A key challenge was finding the right balance between maximizing the leverage of collective experience while protecting confidentiality and individual privacy.

At a technical level, Coday remained a closed internal platform, but one designed to evolve. "Agent-to-agent protocols are not very good today," Couturier observed. "The connections we have with our internal tools wouldn't be the same with external systems. But armed with its memory files, we could move from one system to another—we're not bound to Coday."

Despite external tools such as Claude Code or OpenAI's Codex offering similar functions for developers, Whoz's leaders viewed them as insufficient for company-wide adoption. "Their UI is great for developers," said David Palita, "but you can't put a customer support person or sales rep in there—it's cryptic. We want to use Coday to drive a cultural shift across the whole company, not just in dev."

Despite these limits, Coday's evolution laid the foundation for a broader transformation—the emergence of an agentic operating system at Whoz.

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The Impact of Coday Throughout the Whoz Organization

Within months of its company-wide rollout, Coday was significantly changing the way employees worked in different parts of the organization.

Developers The development team was the first to adopt Coday, training it with information on Whoz's tech stack, coding standards, and security guidelines. It could retrieve Jira tickets, analyze code bases, and even push reviewed code to GitHub. David Palita explained, "In the product we are lucky in that we have artifacts, we have the Jira tickets, we have the code, we have the pull request so they are pit stops along the process where Coday can very easily bring the information from." Audibert added, "If I'm not knowledgeable about a part of the code base, and I have to work on it, I can just run the agent on it and explore, and the agent will get me a developer summary that otherwise could have been very difficult to get." At the same time, Coday helped Whoz to move away from overreliance on "superstars". VP Senior Engineer Vincent Palita added, "We're trying to focus on removing the people-centric way of working, where you have one person that knows everything about the application. We still have this issue at Whoz. We want to be process centric; we want to remove the single point of failure, and that's where Coday is amazing."

Audibert summarized the experience: "With Coday, you can get started very easily on the work and always have a higher point of view on the subject. You keep a nice view of the architecture and the shape of the solution you want to develop." Vincent Palita shared, "I hate to lose time—80% of my job starts with Coday. I usually end up redoing the other 20% with AI." Audibert cautioned about one drawback, "The agent can be very fixated on the perfect solution and the complete answer, and that's not always what we want. Sometimes we just want something that works, that's simple and that can fit." For Vincent Palita, the Whoz context slowed Coday's response time when a fast response was required to a passive question, "It's very Whoz related and we're working on that."

Beyond productivity, Coday was also used as a mediator. When two colleagues disagreed on a technical approach, one pasted the Slack thread into Coday, which analyzed the arguments and explained the reasoning behind each. "This changed their interaction and helped them find common ground," David Palita recalled.

Product management For Product Manager Barthelemy Bidot, Coday became a personal assistant bridging technical and functional work. "What I find most useful is how it supports my work with developers every day," he said. "When a client reports a bug, instead of immediately reaching out to a developer, I ask Coday to check the code base and summarize what's been implemented. Then I can decide if it's a real bug or just a different vision of the feature." Roughly 75% of the time, he began his investigation with Coday before involving developers—saving time and freeing engineering capacity.

Bidot joined Whoz before Coday was a mature tool and had a more traditional onboarding experience. "If someone new joined tomorrow," he reflected, "I'd give them an hour's overview—what we're responsible for, our vision, the key features that we're working on, stuff like that—and then say: if you want to understand more about a feature, your best bet is Coday."

Still, Bidot emphasized the need for human judgment: "It's my responsibility to decide how I use the output of that tool. When Coday writes a user story, I'm responsible for its content. It's a bit of a challenge right now, because it's very easy to produce a lot of content, and a lot of content is not necessarily a good thing." He added, "It's a fantastic tool, and it's making my work a lot faster and better. But it doesn't replace the discussion, the design consideration and the critical thinking that's happening all the time, which is essential in product management."

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Customer support When Mikael Azran, head of client success and delivery, first heard about Coday, he thought it was "just for developers." But after it was connected to Jira, his team created an agent named JiJi, trained on support tickets and responses. "JiJi's answers weren't perfect," he admitted, "but they were at the level of someone with two months of training. Given that it takes three to five months to train people to the level where they are able to answer customers, this wasn't bad."

That first use case triggered further adoption among some members of the team. Azran said, "We saw that the people using Coday were able to manage 20-25% more tickets than the ones who did not. What was really interesting is that the ones processing more tickets were not the most experienced. And then, just by showing people the results of using Coday, very naturally, people started to jump in." The team developed another agent—Jirep—trained to propose replies to clients. Azran commented, "Lead times to actually close tickets did increase initially—the quality of the replies was not good enough so customers kept coming back to us. As the agents improved they went back to the same level as before, and now we're at the point where we're going faster."

Another pair of agents—RiRi and ClientRedactor—handled communication with key clients, analyzing tickets and crafting tailored updates. Azran explained, "We tried to train the agents in as controlled a manner as possible to ensure the quality of the results. For the ClientRedactor, we tracked the results of giving different prompts and guidelines to the agent. We always ask a team member who isn't part of the agent development to review what we're doing to have an outside view." The ClientRedactor's memory was also trained with the output of a series of interviews with client senior executives. Azran commented, "The idea was not only to make our response more relevant, but also to learn to speak the language of the people who are going to receive these updates."

According to Azran, the use of Coday by the client success and delivery team allowed them to personalize and customize their message for each client. He explained, "We can now offer our smaller-contract customers a more tailored, high-quality service—something we previously provided mainly to our largest clients." He reflected, "When we started working with Coday, our aim was to do the same thing for lower cost. But cost is no longer the driver—it's doing things that we would not have even thought of doing if we didn't have Coday."

One example was using Coday to analyze the tone of voice in Jira customer support tickets. This exercise enabled the client success and delivery team to detect early warning signals in a customer account that appeared healthy based on traditional metrics. A longitudinal analysis revealed rising urgency and frustration over time, allowing management to proactively address underlying issues before the relationship deteriorated and restore trust.

Azran started to hire profiles that were more senior and, thanks to Coday, could be trained in about one month. He added, "Our team requires much less support from a management point of view than they did in the past. Our managers are moving from a managing posture, which is, 'I tell you what kind of activities you need to do,' to, 'I'm going to coach you to change the way you're behaving.'" He believed that in 1–2 years, managers could easily double their managerial capacity.

Documentation As head of documentation, Emily Stevens was a one-person team responsible for release notes and service updates for Whoz's largest clients.

Before Coday, preparing documentation for a major release—of which there were 4-5 per year—took one to two weeks. With Coday, she could do it in a single day. After some experimentation, she landed on the approach of giving Coday a brief one sentence prompt to explain the new feature and asking it to write a release note. She then iterated with Coday, asking it to cross check its draft against the Jira ticket or relevant code, and edited the draft until she was satisfied.

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Stevens also spent time iterating with Coday to train it on writing style and formatting. "I trained Coday to give me exactly the formatting I want in HTML," she said. For the writing style, it was more difficult. She said, "I find it hard to prompt and get the right balance for release notes that aren't too marketing, like everything is amazing but are still not too dry. So, I kept basically just giving it feedback and then once it got it, I was like, 'Great, remember that!'" She described her general philosophy, "In general, I found it best to abandon the structured 'I will learn how to use AI thinking' and just be like a kid and play with it."

Coday also helped Stevens adapt content for multiple audiences. "I now use one master document and use Coday to make different iterations—for admins, end users, or a demo script for a video," she explained. I use the time I've saved to understand the features and do more personalized iterations of the notes and videos that will engage various stakeholders." While, in the past she had made a case for expanding the documentation team, "Now, I am told, 'You can have someone when you can prove that Coday can't do it for you.'"

Stevens's work still brought her satisfaction, "I'm still in charge of the story. I give Coday the direction, and it just fills in the pieces for me. I see my role as a storyteller, because AI can use the data to tell a lot of different stories—I need to make it tell the story I have in mind."

Legal Jérôme Balducci, head of business solutions, oversaw Whoz's legal operations despite not having a legal background. He explained, "Given the size of our company, it makes no sense for us to have a legal company—we work with an external lawyer when a legal opinion is required."

To reduce reliance on external counsel—which was expensive and not always readily available—Balducci trained a Coday legal agent in contract negotiations. He said, "We wanted to create an agent with a memory of what was accepted by our external lawyer in the past. I provided Coday with about 50 contracts from past negotiations. Our focus was having consistency—knowing what we can or can't accept," he said. "Coday analyzed the contracts, extracted topics we'd accepted as tradeoffs before, and built guidance for us. It's pretty simple but powerful." The impact was immediate: external legal hours fell from 20 per month to two or three.

Balducci provided an example of a high-stakes use of his legal agent: Whoz was in negotiations on the sale of a new product with an existing client. With just a few hours to go until the contract had to be signed, the client asked for a new clause to be added. Given the time-sensitive nature of the request, Balducci turned to Coday. He explained, "I asked Coday to take a similar clause from a prior contract to use as a template, and to rewrite it using the definition and wording of the client. We were able to get back to the client with a proposal in under one hour and managed to close the deal."

Balducci planned to give Whoz salespeople access to the legal agent for first-round contract discussions: "It can cover 80% of our cases—it's always the same type of discussions."

Marketing The marketing team created a social-media agent that helped colleagues repost LinkedIn updates with a personalized caption. "The reach is better if you repost with your thoughts," David Palita explained. "If you're not much of a writer, or simply don't have the time, the agent takes the LinkedIn post and responds to it, given your position in the company, the stance you want to have on the topic. It proposes different angles to be more business oriented, more market aware, more tech related, etc."

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Agents, Learning, and the Future of Work

The widespread use of Coday at Whoz raised new questions about the nature of learning and ownership in an agentic organization. While, in the past, employees used software as tools to help them do their work; now they were creating agents that could actually do parts of the work for them. Building agents required a strong culture of AI understanding and different skills. Furthermore, by using their agents, employees were training them—embedding their personal methods, preferences, and expertise into Coday's shared memory. This led to practical and ethical questions: who should build agents? How should they be managed? Who owned the benefit derived from agents? And how should personal agents and company-wide agents co-exist within the same system?

The experience also reshaped how people learned and how the company itself learned. Traditionally, learning at Whoz had been individual and incremental—employees improved through experience, coaching, collaboration and training. With Coday, that learning became immediate, collective, and compounding: when one person spent time training and interacting with an agent, the entire organization benefited. As a result, the distinction between individual and organizational learning began to fade. Whoz was no longer just documenting best practices—it was capturing them in real time, learning from the lived experience of human tool interactions through agents that remembered and evolved.

This transformation introduced tensions. For individuals, the question was whether working so closely with agents made them more or less employable. Looking ahead, Whoz might reinforce the agent-first mindset, progressively restricting direct user access to certain enterprise tools and requiring interactions to take place exclusively through Coday's agents. Some employees wondered if relying on Coday's assistance might make them overly specialized in its ecosystem, potentially limiting external mobility. Some others were concerned about what their roles would look like in the future—specifically, whether primarily managing and interacting with agents represented a step too far from the job they had originally signed up for.

For Whoz, the challenge was to ensure that employees continued to build new skills, rather than delegate too much intellectual work to agents. Whoz's culture of experimentation—where employees were encouraged to build, test, and learn from agents—was what allowed Coday to flourish. Maintaining that culture would be essential as the company considered its next step.

Looking beyond short-term productivity gains, the rise of Coday at Whoz raised a more fundamental question: how white-collar work itself might be reinvented as agents moved from copilots to pilots, with humans increasingly focused on intent, constraints, and supervision rather than execution—an approach known as Specification-Oriented Development. As Thibault Maitre, head of international development observed, "At Whoz, this shift is reshaping the relationship between developers and product managers. Product managers can increasingly focus on discovery, understanding customer needs, use cases, and intent. Developers define the frame within which Coday operates, clarifying constraints, highlighting areas of flexibility, and anchoring decisions in the original intent." He added, "Experts can still thrive if they are willing to let AI do much of the execution. It does, however, raise questions about junior talent: how to onboard, train, and give purpose to newcomers."

Coday: A Catalyst for Organizational Change

From the outset, Couturier believed Coday would enable people to do things they had never considered before or had long dismissed as too complex or too time consuming. "Coday is a kind of central point," he reflected. "Everybody starts with the same interface, then calls an agent to work with.

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And if you don't do that, if you continue in the global interface, then at a certain point, Coday will say, 'I'm going to ask this agent, because it's more capable than I am.' Coday is going to start orchestrating your work."

The experience of working with Coday prompted its senior leadership to consider how organizations might function in an agentic era. Couturier envisioned a future where—instead of traditional business processes—organizations would have real-time, dynamic workflows in orchestration. "The critical point for me with Coday is not the result," he mused, "it's really the journey. We can make many mistakes, but they help us to think about the future."

Coday became the centerpiece of Whoz's transformation towards becoming an agentic first organization. "If you don't change the culture of your organization, you will have a productivity issue," Couturier warned. "While the initial 50% productivity gains will come from relatively straightforward applications of AI, the real opportunity lies in much larger, potentially fivefold gains enabled by a deeper rethinking of work itself."

Coday reshaped how the product and engineering teams imagined the future of AI in workforce management. As Gros put it, "Whoz is ultimately about orchestrating work and performing it within the system—and that's exactly the kind of domain where an agentic approach matters." Coday served as a sandbox for rapid experimentation that would have been impossible within the constraints of Whoz's enterprise SaaS platform. Gros explained, "In the B2B world, you can't afford downtime. Internally, we can experiment freely, learn quickly, and explore possibilities without disrupting the production environment."

Beyond its internal impact, Coday began to shape Whoz's external identity. As clients across industries faced disruption from LLMs and agents, Whoz used Coday to educate and inspire them to imagine their own futures. "With Coday, we try to give our clients insights into their own future," Couturier explained. "It gets them thinking—what will our business look like tomorrow?" This consultative approach became a means of making prospective clients curious about Whoz. Couturier said. "When I tell a client we use it internally, it gives them inspiration. They see it, they're intrigued, and then we talk about Whoz."

Presenting Coday at conferences and client events also became a way to strengthen Whoz's brand as a thought leader in agentic transformation. Couturier and his team frequently spoke at industry forums and with clients, using these platforms to explore how AI and agents would reshape consulting, IT services, and knowledge work. For Couturier, sharing this vision externally was part of Whoz's mission. "By doing this, we learn how to imagine the future ourselves, which is one of the most critical capabilities today."

Yet even as Coday strengthened Whoz's culture and external brand, Couturier now faced a difficult strategic choice: what to do with it?

At a Crossroads

After almost two years of development, Coday had become indispensable inside Whoz. The company had not only discovered a new way of working—it had begun redefining what organizational learning, collaboration, and productivity could look like in an agentic enterprise. Yet maintaining two parallel development tracks—Whoz's enterprise platform and Coday's fast-moving agentic framework—was straining the company's limited resources. Couturier said, "We need to increase the number of developers to improve Coday or we'll start cannibalizing the resources we have for Whoz."

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The case for a spin-off was compelling. David Palita added, "We have two very different paces. In Coday, we move quickly, break things, and try the latest model. The product's development is slower and more cautious because we want controlled behavior in the live product for our end users. We have to be extremely careful about data leakage, so we have a lot of scaffolding in that part of our AI use." A standalone Coday could operate faster, attract external funding, and position itself as one of the first purpose-built agentic platforms on the market.

The opportunity extended far beyond Whoz: virtually every software company—and, increasingly, every knowledge-driven organization—was beginning to explore agent-driven workflows. The emerging market for agentic platforms, orchestration layers, and enterprise memory systems dwarfed the niche of a professional services staffing solution. Industry estimates for purpose-built agentic AI platforms ranged from $2–7 billion in 2025 to $25–43 billion by 2030, depending on definitions.[5] In the broader enterprise-AI, knowledge-management, and automation markets, the combined opportunity was almost $100 billion in 2025, and forecast to expand to over $200 billion by 2030.[6]

A spin-off would allow Whoz to focus on its profitable core SaaS business while still benefiting from Coday's success as a shareholder. Yet Couturier also recognized that remaining solely a vertical SaaS provider in professional services exposed the company to potential disruption from LLMs and emerging agentic technologies. The risks for a standalone Coday were also substantial. One concern was whether it could be deployed effectively beyond Whoz's own environment. As Couturier noted, many companies lacked even a basic knowledge base to start from: "They don't have a document describing how they develop software or test it. And if you don't have that, you need to start putting it together. And then as soon as you have that—which is the easy but boring part—then you have to change the culture of the people, because they need to go for it. The real difficulty is changing people's behavior." Outside Whoz's experimental environment, he wondered if Coday could easily take root.

The alternative was to integrate Coday directly into Whoz's core product. The experience of using Coday internally meant that the product team could think about agents in a different way when designing an integrated Whoz product. Couturier mused, "If you don't understand what an agent can do, how it is built, it's far more difficult to see the potential."

That approach offered synergy: the agentic flexibility of Coday could complement Whoz's deterministic backbone to create a single platform capable of orchestrating both humans and agents. Integration would also reinforce Whoz's moat—its enterprise relationships, its ability to scale to hundreds of thousands of users, and its expertise in structured workflows. But it would require Whoz to evolve the skills that its users had and change the nature of its product. Couturier reflected, "Our clients today are the ones who are transforming organizations all around the world, and they are becoming our partners. We could have huge leverage." He wondered, "In Whoz, we do people orchestration. With Coday, we do agent orchestration. Is the next phase the convergence of these two pieces to do people and agent orchestration?"

Yet merging the two worlds was complex. Coday's lightweight architecture encouraged experimentation, while Whoz's enterprise clients demanded reliability and control. Audibert said, "Coday doesn't have all the scaffolding and guard rails that we have in the product. So, it's two different kinds of engines, we would have to find a middle ground so that we can have both." Achieving balance would require new architectural patterns, privacy safeguards, and a zero-trust design to prevent data leakage while preserving agility.

Beyond engineering, the business model was unresolved. The traditional per-seat SaaS structure was misaligned with an agentic platform that consumed tokens and generated value through learning. Usage-based or value-based pricing promised fairness but clashed with large clients' need for budget

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certainty. As Couturier put it, "The value is in the memory—in making tacit knowledge explicit—but it's very hard to price."

A final option was to open-source Coday. This approach would allow Whoz to lean into the broader developer community to maintain and expand the code base, effectively solving the resource constraint problem without increasing internal headcount. There was a strong historical precedent for this: major tech firms frequently released internal tools to set industry standards and attract talent. By making Coday open-source, Whoz could position the framework as the default infrastructure for the agentic era, benefiting from rapid, community-driven iteration that a closed team could never match. However, the trade-off was stark. Making it open source meant giving away the underlying intellectual property that provided Whoz's new competitive edge. It risked commoditizing the technology before Whoz could capture its value, potentially leaving the company with a popular standard but no direct revenue stream to justify the years of development.

As Couturier prepared for an upcoming board meeting, the dilemma remained unresolved. Should Whoz draw a line under the agentic experiment and spin off Coday, open-source it, or reimagine itself as a player in shaping the agentic era and create value from Coday to its customers?

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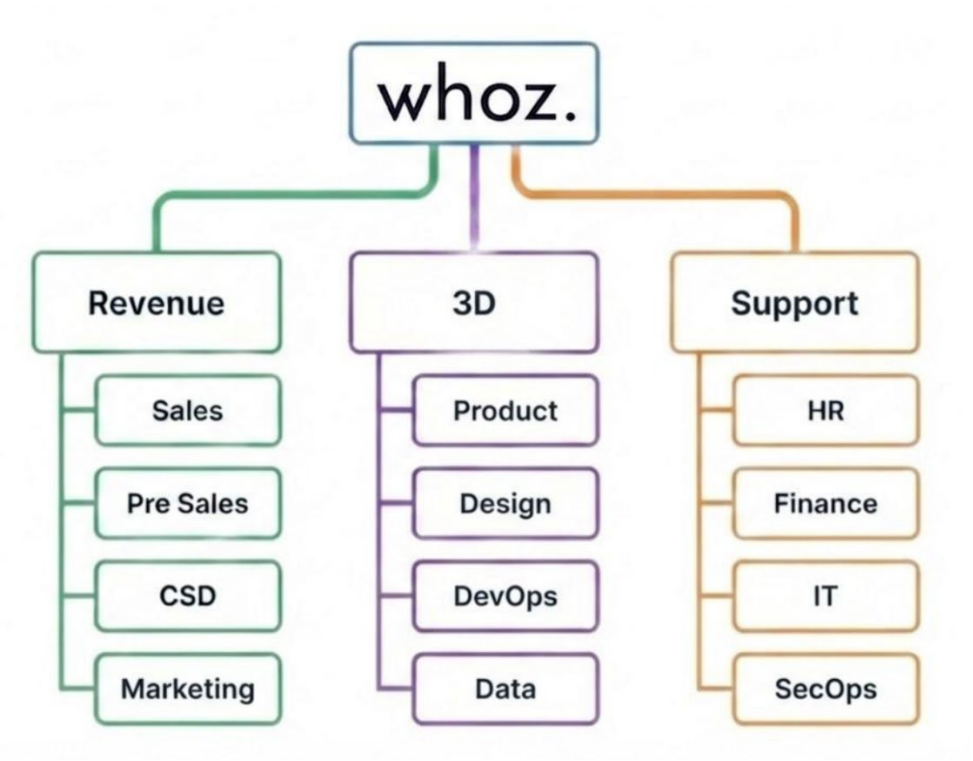
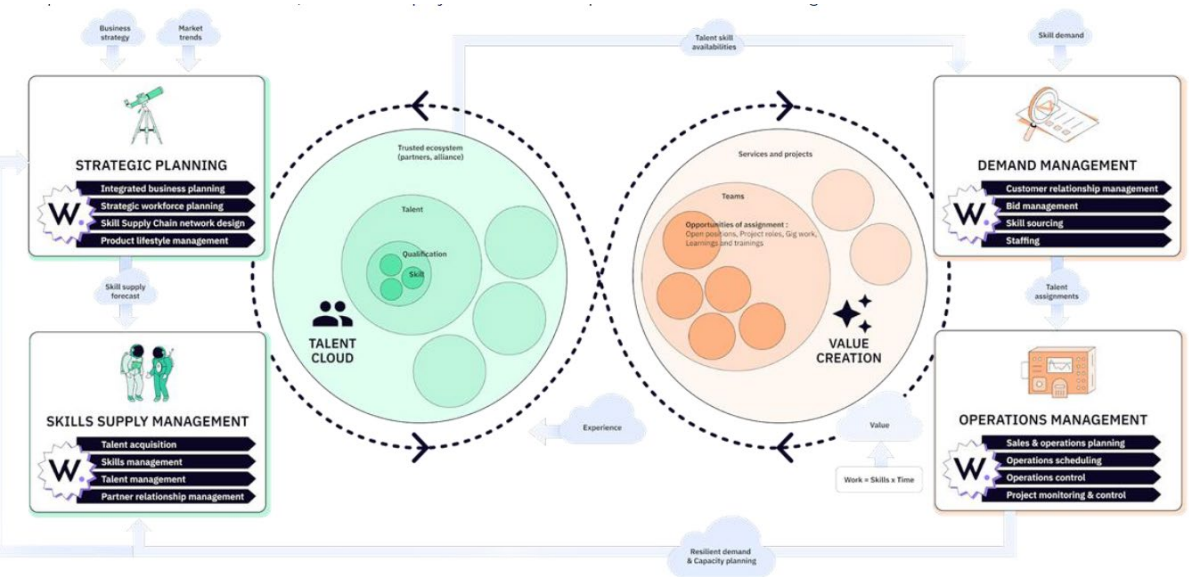
Exhibit 1 Whoz's Organizational Chart



Source: Company document.

Exhibit 2 Whoz's Agile Talent Operating Model



Source:Company document.

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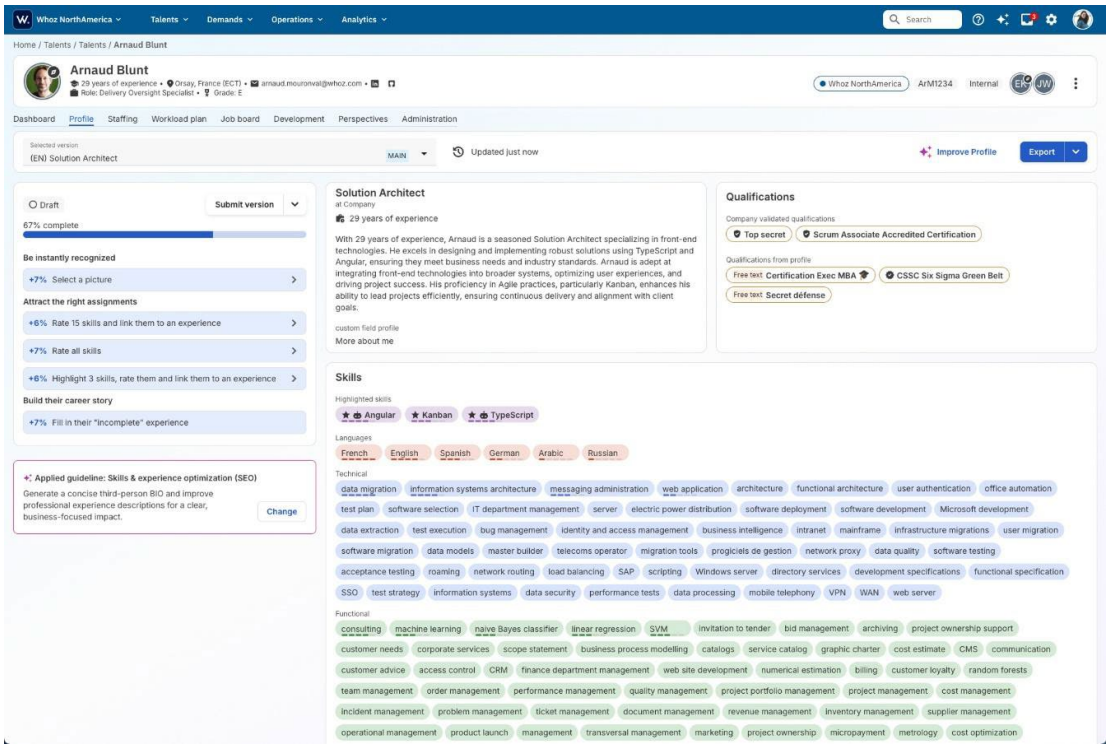
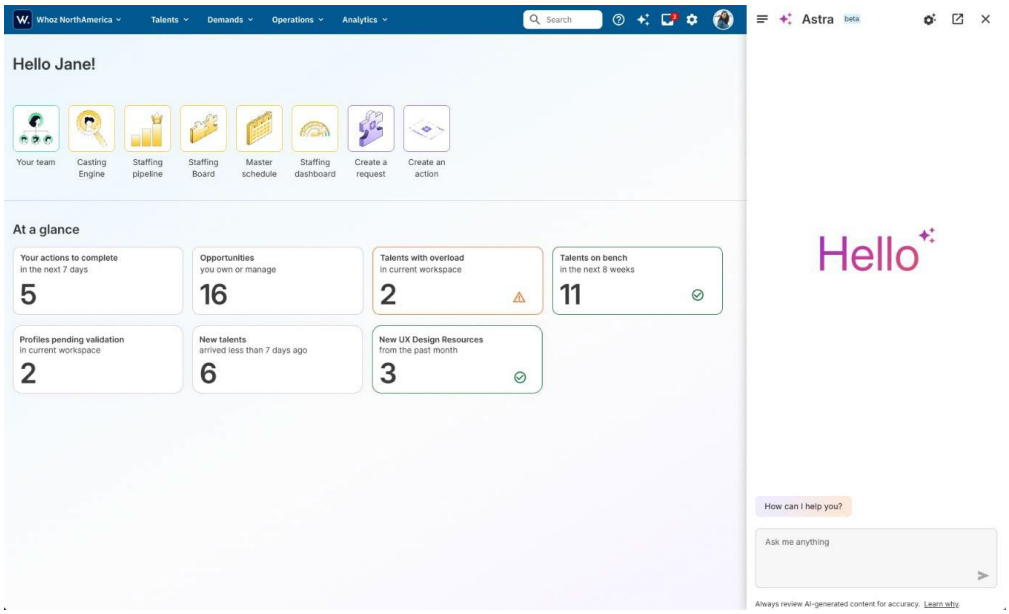
Exhibit 3 Whoz Profile



Source: Company document.

Exhibit 4 Whoz's Business & Staffing Studio Home Page



Source: Company document.

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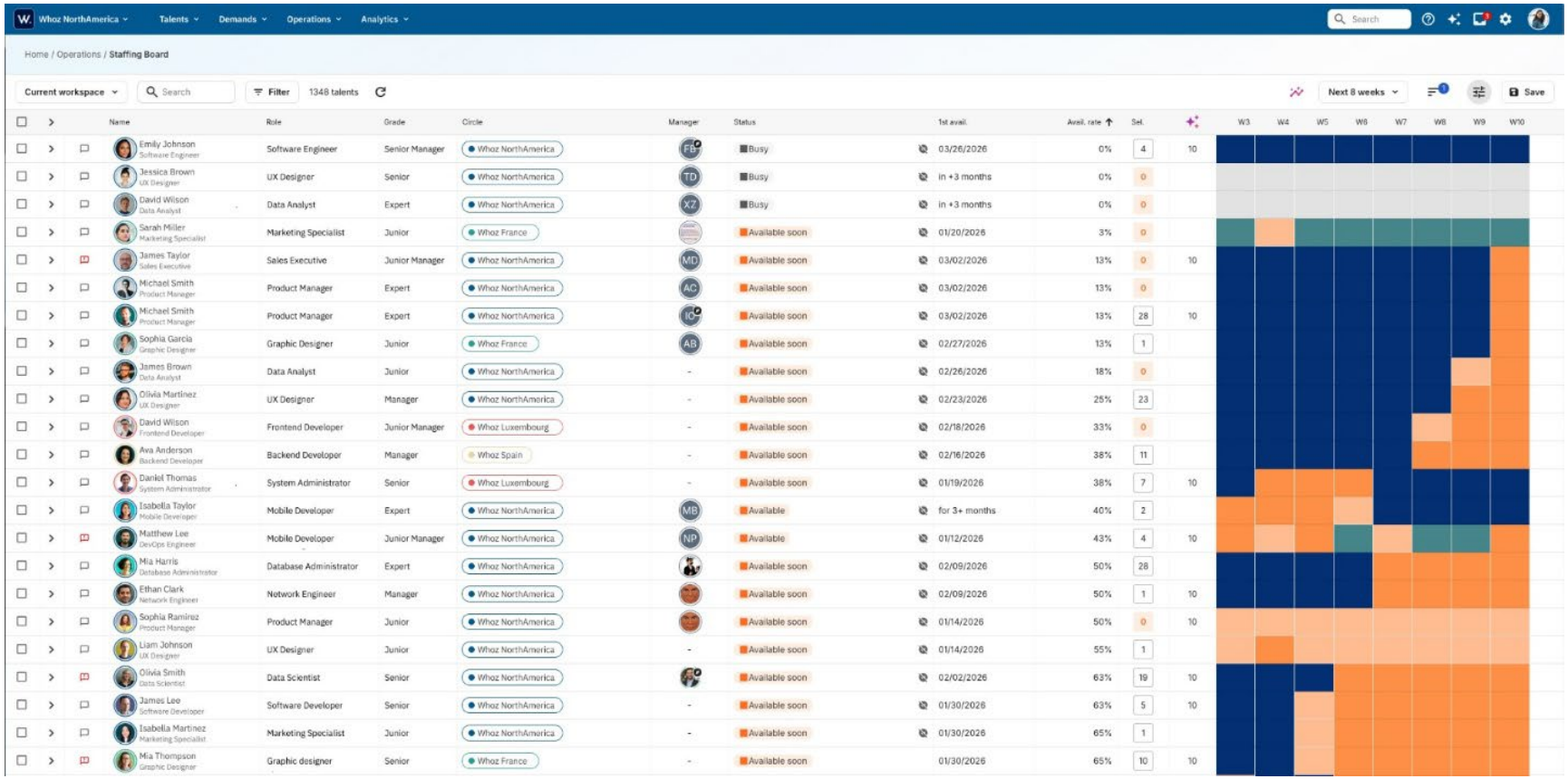
Exhibit 5 Whoz's Staffing Solution

a) Whoz's Staffing Board



Source: Company document.

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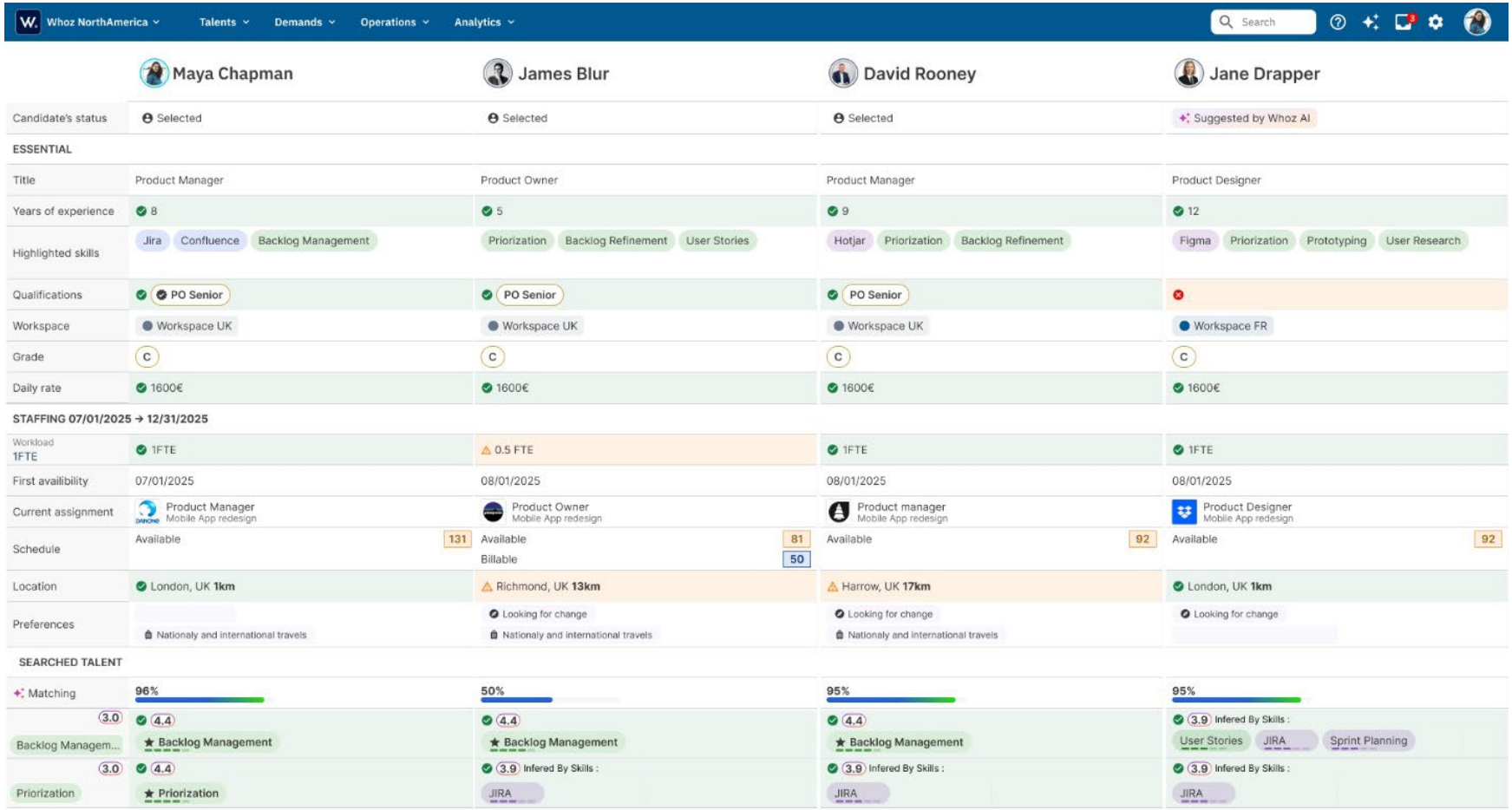
b) Whoz's 'Compare Profiles' Tool



Source: Company document.

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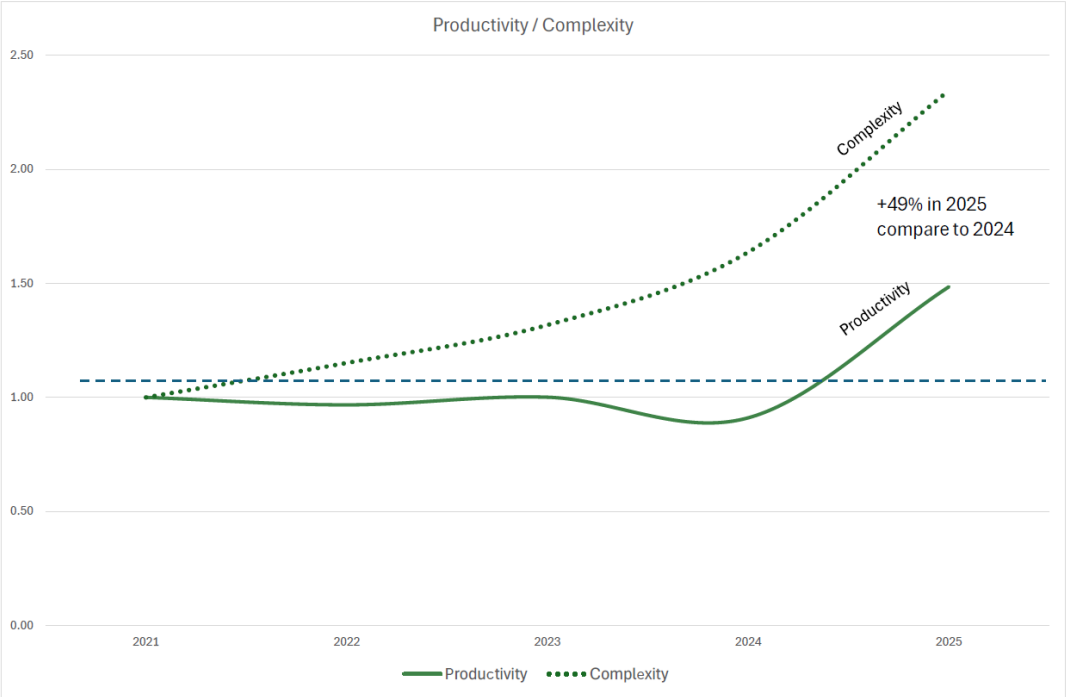
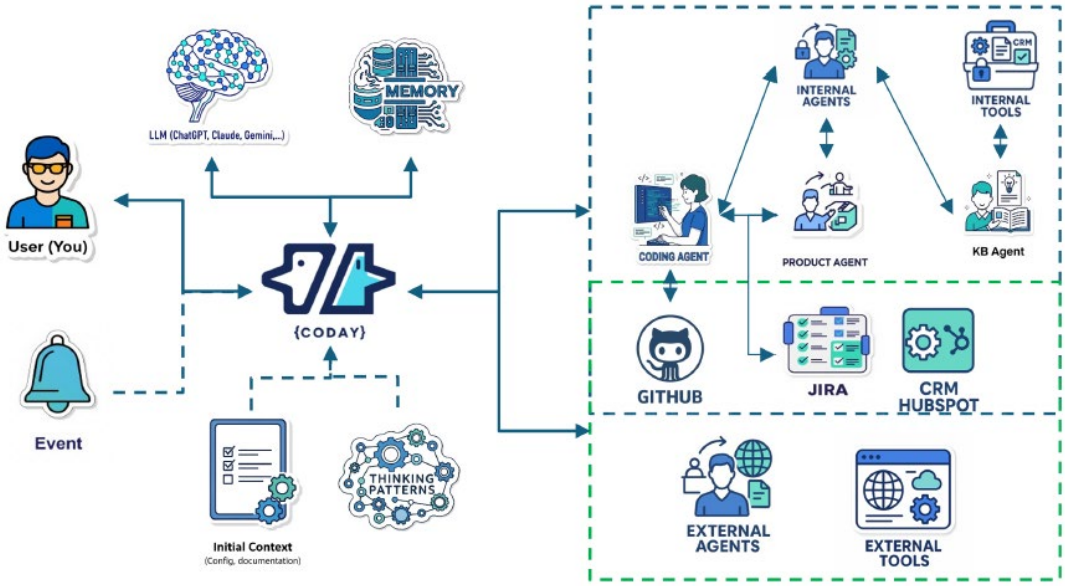
Exhibit 6 Impact of Coday on Global Code Delivery Productivity



Source: Company document.

Exhibit 7 Coday Orchestration



Source:Company document.

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Exhibit 8 Examples of Coday Agent

Core Orchestration

- Coday — Default orchestrator that routes requests to the right specialist agent and provides general assistance.

Accessibility

- a11y — Web accessibility expert ensuring designs and implementations comply with WCAG and best practices.

API and Data Contract Validation

- APIValidator — Validates API implementations against Stoplight/OpenAPI specs to detect schema, field, and endpoint inconsistencies.

Documentation and Content

- DocWriter — Produces clear, structured documentation in the required format (HTML/Markdown) from provided inputs.
- ClientRedactor — Crafts personalized, executive-ready client communications based on release notes and RT analyses.
- Keynote — Builds compelling product release keynotes and narratives for internal/external presentations.
- SalesSummarizer — Transforms meeting notes into concise, CRM-ready summaries with structured insights.
- SocialReposter — Generates tailored LinkedIn repost content aligned with persona, focus, and content relevance.

Release Notes and Client Communications

- releasenote — Runs the multi-stage “Release Note Game” to produce complete, engaging, and technically accurate release notes.
- RiRi — Analyzes release notes and RT tickets to produce client-specific impact analyses and summaries.

Jira/Ticketing and Field Feedback

- Jiray — Internal Jira ticketing and resolution workflow assistant for efficient issue handling.
- BugReporter — Drafts precise, reproducible bug tickets with clear impact, classification, and expected behavior.
- JiJi — Customer Success ticket analysis agent providing root cause, prioritization, and resolution guidance.
- Jirep — Produces professional, client-facing responses to Jira tickets based on JiJi’s analysis.
- WhozRtFinder — Mines RT (Remontées Terrain) tickets to detect trends, patterns, and actionable product insights.

Sales and Account Strategy

- AccountPlanCoordinator — Orchestrates sub-agents to deliver cohesive, end-to-end account plans.
- ApproachStrategyPlanner — Designs approach strategies and plays for winning and expanding accounts.
- CompanyProfileAnalyst — Researches and analyzes company profiles to inform account strategy and planning.
- SalesAccountPlanMaker — Builds structured, data-driven account plans from prospect analysis.
- NeedsAnalysisSpecialist — Elicits and formalizes customer needs to align solutions and value.
- ObjectivesKPISpecialist — Defines measurable objectives and KPIs aligned to commercial strategy.
- StakeholderMapExpert — Maps decision makers and influencers to guide engagement strategies.
- ValuePropositionExpert — Crafts tailored value propositions that connect Whoz capabilities to client outcomes.
- SalesColdCaller — Assists with cold call scripts, targeting, and cadence for Tier-2 prospects.
- ArnaudAmirault — Sales persona agent for human-style sales interactions, messaging, and role-play scenarios.

Customer Success and Support

- CustomerSupportExpert — Provides comprehensive platform support, troubleshooting, and user enablement.

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- ICEMAP — Guides Sales and Success through the ICE + MAP process to prove and realize client business impact.

Product Strategy and Design

- WhozDesigner — Explores product problems, generates solutions, and converts ideas into actionable user stories.
- PMChallenger — Helps PMs break down complex problems to maximize user value while minimizing cost.
- SolutionAgent — Pre-sales partner for solution shaping, scoping, and feasibility assessments.

Engineering, Development, and QA

- Dev — Autonomous development agent able to implement changes with human oversight on critical decisions.
- Howzi — Reviews Angular code against Whoz frontend best practices to provide actionable improvements.
- Storybook — Creates and maintains Storybook stories with robust component analysis and JSDoc.
- E2E — Designs and implements end-to-end tests from Jira tickets following codebase patterns.
- TestCaseRedactor — Produces comprehensive non-regression test cases with clear steps and expected results.
- UserStoryKiller — Reads Jira stories, asks clarifying questions, and builds global implementation plans.
- us-redactor — Writes concise, standard-compliant Jira user stories ready for backlog integration.
- KB43D — Knowledge base assistant that retrieves, correlates, and synthesizes technical/product information.
- Webot — Browser-enabled agent to execute complex web tasks and validations (while respecting auth constraints).

UX Research and Usability

- Digeo — Usability assistant (French only) analyzing user tests and interviews to extract actionable insights.
- WhozUserResearcher — Performs UX data analysis and synthesis to inform product decisions and roadmaps.

Legal and Contracts

- MSA — Reviews and negotiates MSAs and Order Forms, ensuring risk control and contractual clarity.

Finance

- Financial — Handles financial questions, calculations, and scenario analyses supporting business decisions.

Recruiting

- Recruiter — Verifies candidate

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Endnotes

[1] "Whoz Raises EUR25 Million in Funding Led by PSG Equity," Business Wire, May 12, 2022, via Factiva, accessed November 2025.

[2] "Whoz Raises EUR25 Million in Funding Led by PSG Equity," Business Wire, May 12, 2022, via Factiva, accessed November 2025.

[3] Whoz, "Product," "Business & Planning Studio," https://www.whoz.com/en/product/business-staffing-studio/, accessed November 2025.

[4] Whoz, "Product," "Performance Analytics," https://www.whoz.com/en/product/performance-analytics/, accessed November 2025.

[5] Grand View Research, "Enterprise Agentic AI Market (2025 - 2030)," "Enterprise Agentic AI Market Summary," https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/enterprise-agentic-ai-market-report, accessed November 2025; and Mordor Intelligence, Agentic AI Market Size & Share Analysis - Growth Trends & Forecasts (2025 - 2030), "Agentic AI Market Size and Share," https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/agentic-ai-market, accessed November 2025.

[6] Mordor Intelligence, Enterprise AI Market Size & Share Analysis - Growth Trends And Forecast (2025 - 2030), "Enterprise AI Market Size and Share Source," https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/enterprise-ai-market, accessed November 2025.

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